What the ADHD Financial Budgeting App Needs

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What we learned, and what the app must do

About 1 in 14 adults has ADHD, which makes planning, remembering and focusing harder. Money needs all three. Five design guides and two research studies shaped every rule below:

What we learned	So the app must…
Long setups wear people out	Set up in 5 minutes and save your place
Out of sight is out of mind	Show your safe-to-spend number first, and count down to bills
Long lists of numbers are hard to keep in your head	Show money in 3 buckets: Spending, Bills, Savings
Busy, flashing screens overwhelm	Have one choice per screen and calm motion
Missed days and red numbers cause shame	Offer a fresh start and kind words, with no streaks
Reward-and-punish tools backfire	Let people set their own goals and help design the app
Quick, impulsive taps are common	Log spending in 2 taps with undo, and count a triple tap once
Adults with ADHD symptoms save less and put off money choices	Keep choices small, and give savings its own bucket
Trust takes time	Work without a bank link at first

Sources: Accessibility Checker (2026), UXPA (2025), Din Studio (2025), Design Monks (2026), iFactory (2025), Spiel et al., CHI (2022), Bangma et al., PLOS ONE (2020).

Safe and steady

- **Locked tight:** scrambled storage, face or finger unlock, and a 5-minute auto-lock.
- **Private:** money hides when you switch apps; only the last 4 digits of an account show.
- **Steady:** works offline, and never loses or doubles a save.
- **For everyone:** works with screen readers, big text and motion turned off.
- **Built with:** Expo for iPhone and Android, Supabase for backup, Plaid for banks.

The skills we created

A **skill** is a recipe card for Claude Code: it reads the matching card before building each part. **We wrote these 10 skills ourselves:**

Skill	What it teaches Claude Code
mvp-scope	Which features go in the first version
adhd-ux-guidelines	How to make calm, kind screens
safe-to-spend-math	How to do the money math correctly
banking-security	Locks, blur, auto-lock and the double-tap guard
fintech-security-privacy	How to protect keys and bank links
local-data-and-state	How to save data safely on the phone
mobile-accessibility	How to work with screen readers and big text
reminders-and-notifications	How to send gentle reminders
testing-react-native	How to test, starting with what could go wrong
dev-workflow	How to build in small, checked steps

We also added **12 expert skills**: 8 from Expo, plus guides for Supabase, app speed, finding bugs and double-checking work.